

down on the excessive noise they make when spinning at high speeds. In technical terms, this lowering of the speed is called riplock. In poor-quality DVD drives, riplock is responsible for video stutter.

Solution: When choosing a DVD drive, make sure it won't suffer from video stutter - ask people who have bought the same model you're contemplating. Essentially, opt for drives from known manufacturers.

► **Problem:** Some DVDs aren't recognised in your DVD drive.

Cause: The problem lies with the media type. There are two main DVD formats - +R and -R. -R format is more commonly available and hence is usually supported by lot many older drives than +R format. If you have an older DVD drive, then it is possible that it has been manufactured to recognise only one format.

Solution: Check the formats supported by your drive and use media of only that format.

► **Problem:** Your DVD-Writer doesn't play DVD-RAMs.

Cause: Not all DVD-Writers are equipped to handle DVD-RAM. Unlike DVD±RW, DVD-RAM uses phase-change dual technology peppered with magneto-optic features. The main advantage of DVD-RAM is its defect management and faster access speeds. However, as we've mentioned, this format incompatible with most drives.

Solution: Select a drive that features support for DVD-RAM. Drives manufactured by LG, Hitachi, and Matsushita (Panasonic) have support for DVD-RAM.

► **Problem:** You can't burn DVDs faster than the rated speed as you used to do with your CD-Writer.

Cause: Overspeeding is a feature supported only by a handful of drives, and only on selected media types. DVD drives from BenQ and Philips officially support overspeeding; however, you need to use good-quality media or media specially developed for overspeeding.

Solution: Buy a DVD drive that officially supports the overspeeding feature. Also, make sure you use officially certified overspeeding media, for example, Taiyo Yuden. It might be possible to get such media, but it is not commonly available.